

U.S. Customs and
Border Protection

(http://www.cbp.gov)

HOW CAN WE HELP YOU?

Search Help Topics



FREQUENTLY ASKED QUESTIONS

If you are looking for more information about the ESTA application process or to review the Frequently Asked Questions, please explore the help topics below.

COLLAPSE ALL

EXPAND ALL

▼ Most Popular Questions

- When should I submit an application through ESTA?
- How do I complete my partially completed application?
- What is the Electronic System for Travel Authorization (ESTA)?
- Who is eligible to submit an application?
- How long is my ESTA valid for?
- How long does the ESTA application process take?
- How do I correct a mistake on my application?
- What is the difference between an ESTA and a visa?
- How do I check my ESTA status?
- How do I answer the "Sex" dropdown question in the Applicant / Passport Information section of the ESTA application?

▼ ESTA Fee Increase

- What is the new cost of the ESTA application?
- Why is the ESTA application price increasing?
- When will CBP begin to collect the new fee?
- Do I need to re-apply if I already have an approved ESTA?

▼ About ESTA and The Visa Waiver Program

- Are there disadvantages to using the Visa Waiver Program?
- By adding these additional questions, won't ESTA now be the equivalent of an electronic visa?
- Do I need to apply for a new ESTA if my current travel authorization will expire while I'm in the United States?
- Do I need to apply for an ESTA on behalf of my children?
- Do I need to apply for ESTA if I am a citizen of a Visa Waiver Program (VWP) country and...?
- Do I need to apply for ESTA if...?
- Do I need to apply if I'm only transiting the United States en route to another country?
- Do I need to bring a printout or digital copy of my travel authorization to the airport?
- Does a travel authorization guarantee me admission to the United States?
- How do I apply for an ESTA?
- How do I get more information about the Visa Waiver Program?
- If I have a travel authorization through ESTA, do I need to fill out an I-94W?
- Under what circumstances should I apply for a visa instead of an ESTA?
- What are the passport requirements for travel under the Visa Waiver Program?
- What if a Visa Waiver Program applicant is found to be inadmissible?
- What if I have dual citizenship and/or have a passport from more than one country?
- What if I have dual citizenship, but my non-VWP passport is expired or I do not have a passport for that country?
- What is the difference between an ESTA and a visa?
- What is the Electronic System for Travel Authorization (ESTA)?
- What is the Visa Waiver Program?
- When must I obtain a visa to travel to the United States?
- When should I submit an application through ESTA?
- Where do I find information about the Terrorist Travel Prevention Act (The Act)?
- Which countries participate in the Visa Waiver Program?
- Who is eligible to submit an application?
- Who is required to have a travel authorization?
- Why do I need to fill out an ESTA application if I'm traveling to the United States under the Visa Waiver Program?
- Why do I need to fill out an ESTA application?

- Why is authorization under ESTA required for United States-bound travel under the Visa Waiver Program?
- When was Cuba designated a State Sponsor of Terrorism?
- How does Cuba's designation as a State Sponsor of Terrorism impact my travel to the United States under the Visa Waiver Program?
- Why is DHS reducing the ESTA validity period for citizens and nationals of Brunei?

✓ **Completing Your ESTA Application**

- Am I able to save a partially completed application?
- Can I apply for an ESTA without a valid email address?
- Can I apply for an ESTA without having confirmed travel plans?
- Can I use the same email address for multiple applications?
- Can you provide guidance and clarification for some of the Eligibility questions?
- Do all applications in my Group have to be completed in order to pay?
- Do I have to use the new "Upload Your Passport" feature?
- Do I need any specific software to submit an ESTA application?
- How many days will my partially completed Group applications be retained?
- My Country of Issue is not in the ESTA drop down menu, other passport eligibility issues.
- My name contains letters that are not in the American English alphabet. How should I spell my name in the ESTA Application?
- What additional data elements were added to the ESTA application in December 2016?
- What are the additional questions with the new "Enhanced" ESTA application?
- ESTA won't accept my Post-dated passport or my passport has my old name.
- How do I request for a new email verification code?
- How do I verify my email address?
- How long does the ESTA application process take?
- I am having technical difficulties submitting my ESTA Application.
- What happens if I do not verify my email address?
- What happens if the image is not successfully processed by ESTA?
- What happens when I select "Upload Your Passport"?
- What if I use a device that does not have access to a camera?
- What is the process to submit a group of applications?
- When I try to apply for ESTA, I get a message that another application already exists.
- Why do I need to provide a valid email address?

- Why do you need my employer information?
- Why is it necessary to expand the amount of ESTA information being collected from VWP travelers?
- Will I need to verify the email address for each of the applications in my Group?
- Will I receive a notification containing my Application Number?
- Will my ESTA be denied if I leave a mandatory field blank?
- How do I answer the "Sex" dropdown question in the Applicant / Passport Information section of the ESTA application?

▼ Fees and Payment Options

- Can I get a refund if my application is not approved?
- Can I pay for a group of applications later?
- Can I pay for my application later?
- Can I pay for two or more applications with one payment?
- Do you only accept credit cards?
- How do I pay for my application?
- How many applications can I submit with one payment?
- Is there a fee to apply for an ESTA?
- I've been charged more than US \$40.27 for ESTA, why?

▼ Checking Your ESTA Status

- Can I find out the reason my application was denied?
- Can I reapply if my application was denied?
- Does CBP send an email notice when my ESTA is about to expire?
- How do I check my ESTA status?
- How do I renew my ESTA?
- How long is my ESTA valid for?
- How many days will my partially completed Individual application be retained?
- If an application in a group submission receives a "Pending" status, will it delay the processing of the other applications in a group?
- If approved, does my travel authorization guarantee me admission to the United States?
- I'm having trouble checking the status of a group of application
- What do I do if my travel authorization was denied and I need to travel immediately?
- What if I forgot my application number?

- What if I forgot my group ID?
- What should I do if I'm not approved for travel?
- When I submit the payment for a group of applications, will I receive the ESTA status for all of the applications at the same time?
- When will I hear back if I'm approved?

✓ Updating Your Information

- How can I correct a mistake regarding Passport Issuance Date or Passport Expiration Date after completing my application?
- How do I complete my partially completed application?
- How do I correct a mistake on my application?
- How do I retrieve my application?
- How do I update the information on my application?
- My group is locked and I cannot use the Group ID. How can I access my application?
- What if I forgot my application number?
- What information can I update?
- What should I do if my passport information has changed or expired?
- When do I need to reapply for an ESTA?
- Why can't I add more applications to my group?

✓ Privacy and Security

- How does the U.S. Government protect the privacy of ESTA data and who has access to it?
- How long is my application data stored?
- How will CBP use my social media information collected through the additional question that was added to the ESTA application in December 2016?
- Is my credit card information safe?
- Is my information secure?
- Is my information shared with anyone?
- Is my payment information secure?

For additional inquiries about the ESTA application process or the Visa Waiver Program, visit the CBP Info Center (https://help.cbp.gov/s/?language=en_US).

CONTACT SUPPORT

Traveler Communications Center

Call: **1-202-325-8000**

To submit an inquiry:

CBP Info Center (<https://help.cbp.gov>)

24 hours per day, 7 days a week

HELPFUL LINKS

Dept. of Homeland Security:

DHS.gov (<http://www.dhs.gov>)

Customs and Border Protection:

CBP.gov (<http://www.cbp.gov>)

CBP.gov/travel (<http://www.cbp.gov/travel>)

SITE POLICIES

ACCESSIBILITY (<http://www.cbp.gov/site-policy-notices/accessibility>)

PRIVACY STATEMENT (</privacystatement?lang=en>)

VULNERABILITY DISCLOSURE (<https://www.cbp.gov/document/directives/vulnerability-disclosure-program-policy-and-rules-engagement>)

Paperwork Reduction Act: An agency may not conduct or sponsor an information collection and a person is not required to respond to this information unless it displays a current valid OMB control number and an expiration date. The control number for this collection is 1651-0111. The estimated average time to complete this application is 23 minutes. If you have any comments regarding this burden estimate you can write to U.S. Customs and Border Protection, Office of Regulations and Rulings, 90 K Street, NE, 10th Floor, Washington DC 20229. Expiration May 31, 2026.

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